



Beaconhouse National University



Undergraduate Student Handbook

2024-Edition

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PART-I

Message from the Vice Chancellor

Greetings,

As Pakistan's first not-for-profit liberal arts university, we are committed to excellence across all disciplines we offer. The journey of our students, however, must go beyond academics. At BNU's purpose-built campus, we offer a wholesome college experience where each student is encouraged to discover their passion and prepare to pursue their professional dreams.

We work diligently to identify students with the potential to benefit from the BNU experience and equip them with the tools to become responsible and caring citizens and leaders in their respective disciplines. We always seek to build synergies, not only within BNU but with peer institutions in Pakistan and abroad, and to create an intellectual environment where both teaching and research thrive – in ways that contribute to a prosperous, just and sustainable society in Pakistan.

BNU recognizes its responsibility to shape the future of our upcoming generation. The entire BNU community is committed to preparing our students for whatever tomorrow may bring. We wish to see each of them make us, and the country, proud – in whatever they do and wherever they go.

We are obsessed with excellence and expect our students to join us with the same spirit and determination. Our twenty-year journey offers a remarkable testament to our success in doing so. And we are determined to keep building on it.

We welcome you to the BNU community and offer you an experience you will cherish for the rest of your life.

Dr. Moeed W. Yusuf

Disclaimer: Beaconhouse National University Handbook

This Student Handbook has been prepared by Beaconhouse National University (BNU) solely to provide students with essential information about the university, policies, procedures, and resources. By using or referring to this handbook, you acknowledge and agree to the following:

- 1. Not a Contract:** This handbook is not a legally binding contract between the students and BNU. It serves as a source of information and guidelines for students' understanding of our institution's operations and expectations. Any conflicts between this handbook and official university policies or agreements will be resolved in favor of the latter.
- 2. Official Policies:** While efforts have been made to ensure the accuracy of the information in this handbook, the official and most up-to-date policies and procedures of BNU can be found in official university publications, such as the university website or specific policy documents.
- 3. Subject to Change:** The content of this handbook is subject to change without notice. BNU reserves the right to update or revise the information contained herein, including policies, regulations, and procedures. It is the responsibility of the students to stay informed about any updates or changes.
- 4. Personal Responsibility:** Students are responsible for understanding and adhering to the policies, rules, and regulations outlined in this handbook and any other official university documents. Ignorance of these policies does not excuse non-compliance.
- 5. Non-Liability:** BNU shall not be responsible for any consequences resulting from actions or decisions made based on the information provided herein.
- 6. Contact Information:** For questions or concerns related to the content of this handbook or any university policies, students are encouraged to contact the appropriate university offices or departments for clarification and guidance.
- 7. Acknowledgment:** Your access to this handbook signifies your acknowledgment and acceptance of the terms and conditions outlined in this disclaimer and content of the document.

Beaconhouse National University is committed to providing a safe, inclusive, and supportive educational environment for all students. We encourage you to make the most of your educational journey with us and to seek assistance and guidance when needed.

Not-for-profit Status

Beaconhouse National University, a not-for-profit status, which means it is established for educational, research, and public service purposes rather than for generating profits for shareholders or owners. Like other Not-for-profit universities, BNU reinvests any surplus funds back into the institution to support its mission and educational programs.

Vision

"To be a world-class institution of higher learning, recognized for excellence in education, research, and community engagement.

Mission

To provide high-quality education, foster critical thinking, creativity, and innovation, and promote a diverse and inclusive learning environment. Beaconhouse National University is dedicated to preparing students to excel academically, professionally, and personally. We strive to be a hub of knowledge creation and dissemination through research and scholarship across various disciplines. We contribute to the development of individuals who are socially responsible, ethically aware, and equipped to meet the challenges of a rapidly changing world. We are committed to serving our community and nation by nurturing the talents and aspirations of our students and faculty.

Core Values

Academic Excellence: Commitment to maintaining high academic standards, fostering intellectual growth, and promoting excellence in teaching, research, and scholarship.

Integrity: We uphold the principles of academic and ethical integrity, fostering a culture of honesty, transparency, and accountability among our students, faculty, and staff.

Innovation: BNU encourages a spirit of innovation, creativity, and critical thinking, where new ideas are nurtured, explored, and applied to advance knowledge and address societal challenges.

Diversity and Inclusion: Embracing diversity in all its forms and promoting an inclusive environment where individuals from different backgrounds, cultures, perspectives and abilities can thrive and learn together.

Community Engagement: BNU is dedicated to making a positive impact on our local and global communities. We actively engage with society through research, outreach programs, and partnerships that address pressing issues and contribute to social wellbeing.

Student-Centered: We prioritize the needs and aspirations of our students, fostering their personal and intellectual growth. BNU is dedicated to providing a supportive and nurturing educational experience that focuses on their holistic development, well-being, and success.

Ethical Citizenship: We instill in our students a sense of ethical responsibility and civic engagement. We aim to graduate individuals who are socially aware, culturally sensitive, and committed citizens who contribute positively to society and making a difference in the world.

Continuous Learning: Emphasizing lifelong learning for both students and faculty, promoting ongoing personal and professional development.

Global Perspective: Preparing students to thrive in a globalized world by providing them with international exposure and a global perspective on issues and challenges.

Sustainability: Commitment to environmental and social sustainability, including responsible use of resources and consideration for the planet's future.

PART-II

1. About Beaconhouse National University

Beaconhouse National University (BNU) is Pakistan's first not-for-profit liberal arts university. Established in 2003, its primary goal is served by providing quality higher education in the arts, design, architecture, media, humanities, social sciences, psychology, business and management sciences, and information technology disciplines. In 2005, BNU received the degree-awarding charter from the Government of Punjab.

The university came into existence thanks to substantial contributions from several benefactors, primarily the Kasuri family, Hussain Dawood family, Dr. Parvez Hassan, Mr. Izzat Majeed, and the Government of Punjab, among others.

The university's purpose-built 35-acre campus features academic blocks, a library, administration facilities, a multi-story cafeteria, sports courts, and on-campus boarding for national and international students.

The campus is equipped with modern infrastructure, including lecture halls, auditoriums, art and design studios, new media and film technology facilities, as well as computing and psychometric labs, facilitating the seamless transfer of applied knowledge.

BNU's mission revolves around nurturing empowered and impactful global citizens within a diverse, socially conscious, cross-disciplinary, liberal arts environment. The university prides itself on offering equal opportunities and serving as a nationally recognized institution of higher education that aspires to become Pakistan's ambassador in the realm of liberal arts. This commitment is evident through values like inclusiveness, participatory leadership, academic freedom, and a merit-based admission policy at all administrative and academic levels. We are also the only university in Pakistan that receives students from all eight SAARC countries.

The university is dedicated to ensuring that no deserving student is denied access due to financial constraints. To this end, BNU has established generous need-based and merit-based scholarship programs for both new and existing students.

BNU isn't merely a degree-granting institution; it actively contributes to the expansion of knowledge and participates in ongoing discussions and dialogues both within and beyond the country's borders. The university fosters research and practice communities in the disciplines it teaches, aligning with areas of socio-economic and cultural significance to the region and beyond.

The faculty at BNU includes visionary educators, accomplished artists, renowned designers, experienced curators, international development experts, published researchers, and established practitioners from diverse backgrounds.

BNU is committed to maintaining a favorable student-faculty ratio to ensure effective learning. Moreover, BNU encourages a vibrant co-curricular atmosphere, promoting student engagement in various extracurricular and community programs. The achievements of BNU's alumni, both nationally and internationally, and their placements in esteemed institutions for further education validate the university's commitment to excellence.

2. Schools at the University

2.1: Mariam Dawood School of Visual Art and Design (MDSVAD)

Mariam Dawood School of Visual Arts and Design (MDSVAD) welcomes new forms of visual experience and offers a multidisciplinary approach as a way to explore the connection between art, design, and different branches of knowledge. Art and design education must equip both faculty and students with adaptive tools, skills, and strategies to develop multi-modal ideas relevant to the changing interconnections and contexts of global learning.

MDSVAD encourages experimentation and aims to ensure that each student is visually articulate, conceptually mature, and equipped with the ability to consolidate ideas and concepts. Providing our students with the opportunity to achieve their creative, analytical potential is a primary objective, with a focus on being responsible citizens and thinkers to contribute to the social fabric of the places they inhabit. Our ever-evolving curriculum is based on constant introspection and revision of our program, keeping it at par with international standards and trends in education. We owe this in large part to our faculty, drawn from diverse backgrounds from all parts of the country and abroad. They are well-known practicing professionals in their respective fields, and it is their hands-on knowledge of contemporary and traditional practice that guides the experience of students. The faculty regularly participate in local and international exhibitions, undertake design and craft community projects and in seminars, conferences, and workshops.

MDSVAD believes in taking the lead in celebrating diversity through creative inquiry. From the outset, our students have the choice of cutting across disciplines, blurring and questioning existing lines, and engaging in a close dialogue between local and global perspectives. MDSVAD's students have qualified for Fulbright scholarships, international residencies, projects, and exhibitions.

The School is proud to host art and design students from all SAARC countries. They are supported by the South Asia Foundation and the UNESCO Madanjeet Singh Institute of South Asian Arts (UMISA). Sharing teaching and learning experience with people from other parts of the world helps build enduring relationships, making BNU-MDSVAD a truly unique institution in the region.

Following undergraduate programs are offered at MDSVAD:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
Bachelor in Arts (Hons) Interdisciplinary Expanded Design & Art (IEDA)	8	131
Bachelor in Fine Arts- Visual Arts	8	131
Bachelor of Design. Visual Communication Design	8	131
Bachelor of Design Textile, Fashion and Accessory Design with specialisation in: ➤ Textile & Fibre ➤ Fashion ➤ Jewellery & Accessories	8	131

2.2: Razia Hassan School of Architecture (RHSA)

At Razia Hassan School of Architecture (RHSA), we believe architectural studies must be pursued with professional aims and humanistic values. Architectural studies must be a synthesis of arts, humanities, and sciences grasped through the rigors of intellect and practice, the results of which are aesthetically judged and technically understood. Our commitment to the highest professional and cultural aspirations is achieved through innovative pedagogies applied through challenging research-based projects.

The emergent respectability of architectural education in Pakistan heralds the possibilities of new architecture-related developments beyond normative practices. RHSA aims to capture this enthusiasm in pursuit of a mission-oriented education that can improve the quality of life, affordably and sustainably without compromising the ideals of professional education. The academic program closely follows the aspirations and requirements of the HEC-PCATP (Higher Education Commission and the Pakistan Council of Architects and Town Planners) National Curriculum of Architecture. A carefully structured balance is created between the studies of historical precedents, critical analysis of contemporary issues, theoretical formulations, applied sciences and technology, and project-based studios. All attempts are made to create an interdisciplinary educational atmosphere through shared electives with other schools at BNU.

While current trends in architectural education leave limited opportunities for revisiting the professional curricula, BNU is committed to remaining experimental in search of spin-off

specializations in the service of built environments: building economics, life-cycle costing wards, comprehensive sustainability, designed flexibility towards adaptive reuse of buildings, energy sensitive building subsystems like visible HVAC subsystems, energy sensitive hardware especially windows, lighting and acoustic products, human factor-integrated furniture design, accessibility and safety details for the handicapped and interior architecture among others. The School of Architecture specializes in connecting to the contemporary world. To this end, numerous links have been created with European, British, Canadian, and American universities. The state-of-the-art campus is equipped with facilities to share online lectures and studio presentations with faculty and other universities. The building is also designed to facilitate student experimental constructions to understand architecture's structural, constructional, and environmental necessities.

Following undergraduate programs are offered at RHSA:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
B. Arch. (Bachelor of Architecture)	10	170
BID (Bachelor in Interior Design)	8	131

2.3: Seeta Majeed School of Liberal Arts and Social Sciences

The Department of Liberal Arts (DLA) offers a unique interdisciplinary program in Liberal Studies that combines the best of social sciences and humanities. The programs include courses from multiple academic disciplines, including Anthropology, Gender studies, History, Literature, Philosophy, Political Science, International Relations and Sociology. The first year of foundation courses is designed to help students develop the essential skills of critical thinking, analytical reasoning, and effective communication through the written and spoken medium.

After exploring the introductory level social sciences and humanities courses, the students are encouraged to pursue courses based on their primary academic interests. The departmental courses are supplemented by those offered by the various BNU schools (School of Visual Art & Design (SVAD), School of Media & Communication (SMC), and the Institute of Psychology). The program has a strong research focus, and the students are provided with rigorous training in various research methodologies. This culminates in a senior thesis project in the final year which serves as the capstone for every student's academic endeavor.

It is widely acknowledged that the relationship between the Liberal Arts and the Social Sciences is and should be complementary and integrative. At the Seeta Majeed School of Liberal Arts and Social Sciences (SLASS), we have designed programs that exemplify this symbiosis so that our students receive well-rounded education while simultaneously being well-grounded and rooted in their chosen disciplines.

Conforming to the vision of BNU as a Liberal Arts institution, SLASS strives to disseminate quality education and make significant research contributions on the most pressing socio-economic issues at the local and national levels. It also aspires to prevent brain drain in the country by offering higher quality education and making Liberal Arts an important academic priority at BNU, besides expanding its base in the discipline to offer diversified concentrations and electives for students in other schools.

Following undergraduate programs are offered at SMSLASS:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
BA (Hons) in Social Sciences with Major in: ➤ Liberal Studies ➤ Major in Liberal Studies and Minor in Media Studies ➤ Major in Liberal Studies and Minor in Theatre, Film and TV	8	131
BA (Hons) in Social Sciences with a Major in Liberal Studies and Specialization in History	8	131
BA (Hons) in Social Sciences with Specialization in Political Science	8	131

2.4: School of Media and Mass Communication (SMC)

The School of Media and Mass Communication (SMC) is dedicated to the proposition that knowledge, creativity, and skills are vital for the development of modern democratic societies in this era of globalization. The SMC attempts to establish a center of excellence focused on knowledge, creativity, research, service, and professional skills in the field of media and mass communication.

The new educational concern with media is born out of a convergence of ideas and technologies, with 'new media' at the forefront. The range of alternative and overlapping sources of information and entertainment, instruction, and art is more extensive than ever before. This communication

revolution brought about by new technologies and changing social and leisure patterns takes on an added force in education. Mass communication shapes public opinion, interprets culture and its values that bind society together and transmits information and knowledge in nurturing a free society. The SMC, through an interdisciplinary approach, aims to impart diverse knowledge and ideas that enable students to fulfill their responsibilities in a democratic and pluralistic society within a global village, prepare professionals in the field of media and mass communication who are able to exercise their freedom with a conscious awareness of the constitutional rights of citizens and equip students with the required tools and skills to cope with the innovations taking place in international media and prepare them for the challenges thrown up by the information age.

Students are trained to become critical and creative thinkers, ethical professionals accountable for their performance, skilled professionals who can use print, electronic, new media, and other forms of communication with equal ease, and media persons who work towards enlightenment and moderation. Students are assessed through a series of seminars, assignments, and individual research projects.

Following undergraduate programs are offered at SMC:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
Department of Journalism (SMC-JOR):		
➤ BS Journalism and Media Studies	8	130
➤ BS Communication and Immersive Media	8	130
Department of Theatre, Film and TV (SMC-TFT):		
➤ BA (Hons) in Social Sciences with major in Theatre, Film and TV Studies	8	130

2.5: School of Computer and Information Technology (SCIT)

No technology has had such a profound impact on human civilization in such a short span of time as Information and Communication Technology (ICT). The pervasive benefits of technology are being experienced in every sphere of life; in fact, ICT has become a propellant of advancement and growth in all fields of human activity.

The above scenario puts immense responsibility on all those involved in conceiving, designing, and specifying ICT systems. This requires technical acumen to assess the relative merits of various

technologies along with the foresight to envisage their impact on the users of ICT systems and society.

The School of Computer and Information Technology (SCIT) is equipped with state of the art facilities including an impressive lab. Co-curricular activities are encouraged under the aegis of different student societies. Students are eligible to receive funding for their Final Year projects from National R&D Fund's IGNITE program.

Following undergraduate programs are offered at SCIT:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
BSc (Hons) in Computer Science	8	130
BSc (Hons) in Management and Business Computing	8	130

2.6: School of Education (SE)

The English Language Unit under the flagship of School of Education offers the following courses to the undergraduate students:

Courses	Credit Hours
Foundation English	3
Communication Skills I	3
Communication Skills II	3

The objective of the English Language Unit (ELU) is to offer students a rigorous academic immersion by furnishing them with language and study competencies crucial for academic achievement. The courses are designed to empower students with the language proficiencies required for effective study in English. Additionally, it helps students from various backgrounds adjust to the academic culture and practices of university study, enabling them to derive optimal advantage from their degree programs.

2.7: School of Management Sciences (SMS)

BNU's School of Management Sciences (SMS) is committed to providing world-class education with a focus on real-world practice to help our students develop skills that are fundamental to assuming leadership and managerial roles in the industry. The world-class faculty at the Management Sciences (SMS) brings its experience to the table and provides students with an unmatched academic as well as professional experience. SMS aims to train its graduates to take up careers in modern corporate entities.

We design and make our programs available for motivated and committed learners only. Our business programs offer a distinct blend of courses covering key areas of marketing, management, finance, supply chain economics, banking, digital marketing, financial technology (fin-tech) and digital finance, information systems, business intelligence, business ethics, business laws and regulations, quantitative techniques, business communication and Hospitality Management.

The Department of Hospitality Management at Beaconhouse National University (BNU) provides an innovative curriculum developed in collaboration with the Hashoo School of Hospitality Management (HSHM), ensuring alignment with industry standards set by the Confederation of Hospitality (CTH) UK. This distinctive curriculum not only allows students to pursue a four-year bachelor's degree but also enables them to earn internationally accredited CTH qualifications simultaneously. Furthermore, students can transfer credits and fulfill parts of their degree at any CTH-affiliated institution worldwide.

Our comprehensive program encompasses various areas, including management, human resources, hospitality technology, food and beverage operations, and service delivery, as well as core business principles in marketing and accounting. The Department of Hospitality Management aims to address the growing demand for skilled professionals in the hospitality sector, provide students with a relevant and thorough education, enhance the university's reputation, cultivate strong ties with the industry, and contribute to the nation's economic progress by producing capable graduates ready to make significant contributions to the hospitality and tourism fields.

The Department of Economics provides students with the chance to enrich both their personal and professional growth within a highly supportive academic environment, empowering them to assume leadership roles. Graduates of the department gain practical experience in research, addressing real-world issues, and applying quantitative techniques while engaging in their research projects or theses.

Quality education has been a concern since the inception of the School of Management Sciences (SMS). The gradual rise in the criteria for admission applications over time and strict monitoring of the academic performance of our students are clearly indicative of our foresight and vision. We combine our activity-based, interactive, and practical pedagogy with industrial visits and invited lectures to enhance the learning of our students through academia-industry linkages.

Following undergraduate programs are offered at SMS:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
Department of Management Sciences (-DMS)		
BS Business Intelligence and Analytics	8	130
BBA (Hons) Specialization in:		
➤ Finance	8	135
➤ Marketing		
➤ Supply Chain Management		
➤ Human Resource Management		
➤ Business Intelligence		
Department of Economics (ECO)		
B.Sc. (Hons) in Economics	8	132
BS (Hons) Major in Economics with Minor in Data Sciences and Analytics	8	132
BSc (Hons.) with Major in Economics and Minor in Media Studies	8	135
Department of Hospitality Management		
BS Hospitality Management	8	133

2.8: Institute of Psychology (IP)

The Institute of Psychology (IP) grew out of the Department of Applied Psychology, established at BNU in 2004, and was one of the first higher education facilities in the subject in the private education sector. Over and above the core courses in the discipline of psychology, the Institute offers innovative courses that promote independent critical thinking and instill analytical skills among the students, such as Debates and Current Trends and Issues in Psychology, Seminars on Indigenous and Cross-Cultural Developments in Psychology and specialized workshops conducted by practicing psychologists in the field. Over the years, these programs have motivated the students to actively carry out research on indigenous issues under the keen guidance of expert

supervisors. The Institute can boast of fully equipped Experimental, Social, and Psychometric laboratories that provide students substantial opportunities to hone their practical skills and complete a mandatory final year project and internship.

The research output of the Institute is impressive, and publications of the faculty and the students appear regularly in National and International Research Journals of universal academic repute. We are proud that several of our students have been awarded prestigious scholarships and have been able to enroll in Ivy League Universities. Furthermore, the employment rate of our graduates is extremely encouraging. Our graduates are working as outstanding, competent professionals and have been absorbed in hospitals and private clinics as clinical psychologists, in schools as school counselors, in the armed services as psychologists, and in academia as researchers and teachers. Several of them are also serving in special education institutions, while some of them are curriculum planners for different school systems.

The following undergraduate program is offered at IP:

Programs	Semesters	Credits
B.Sc. (Hons) Applied Psychology	8	131

PART-III

Objectives of the Undergraduate Education Policy (from HEC 2023)

The primary objective of the policy is to promote student success which is envisioned as the ability to comprehend and apply conceptual knowledge, acquire professional skills and competencies, and act as an individual having strong civic and ethical values of tolerance and inclusiveness. The specific objectives of the policy include the following:

- 1. Competency Based Learning:** To develop the 21st century outcomes of the learning process focusing mainly on:
 - **Knowledge** (disciplinary, interdisciplinary, epistemic, procedural, etc.).
 - **Skills** (communication and soft skills, proficient use of ICT, integrated, analytical and quantitative reasoning, creative thinking, etc.).
 - **Professional Behavior** (self-regulation, time management, integrity, intellectual curiosity, intellectual openness, etc.).
 - **Interpersonal Attributes** (empathy, self-efficacy, teamwork, etc.).
- 2. Balance between Breadth and Depth:** To ensure that the undergraduate education focuses not only on the main field of specialization but also provides exposure to the interdisciplinary areas of knowledge.
- 3. Applied Knowledge:** To promote application of academic knowledge to effectively respond to real life, entrepreneurial and industry challenges and requirements.
- 4. Emphasis on Creativity:** To equip students with the sense and ability to demonstrate creativity, curiosity, exploration and reflective problem solving.
- 5. Terminal Degree:** To design all undergraduate degrees with an objective of making them sufficient to meet the requirements of the job market. It will however be at the discretion of the graduates to seek further education.

ADMISSION CRITERIA

The admission offer shall be made upon satisfying the following criteria:

BA (Hons) / BSc (Hons) Degree Programmes

(i) To be eligible for admission to undergraduate programmes, a candidate must at the very least satisfy any one of the following requirements: -

- FA / F.Sc. with at least 2nd division (i.e. 495 marks)*.
- O-levels (at least 6 subjects with IBCC equivalence) and 3 A-levels. Advanced Subsidiary (AS) will not be taken into account.
- High School Diploma and International Baccalaureate (IB) result with a CGPA of at least 2.50.

Note: Equivalence Certificate from IBCC is mandatory for all international qualifications i.e. O-Levels/A-Levels, High School Diploma, and International Baccalaureate, or equivalent.

- * For B.Arch. & BBA, minimum 60% marks (660) are required in Intermediate or an Average C in A-Level.
- * For Economics, minimum 50% marks (550) required.
- * For Software Engineering, minimum 50% marks (550) are required in Intermediate (with Math or Biology or equivalent).
- * Students of Intermediate (Pre-Medical Group) will be required to take deficiency courses in Mathematics of 6 Credit hours in their first year of study.

(ii) Passing of BNU's written aptitude test & interview

- (iii) The overall merit for admission offers in the undergraduate degree programmes will be determined on the basis of the aggregate as follows:

Break up	Percentage
Admission Test & Interview	25%*
A-Levels / Intermediate	45%
O-Levels / Matriculation	30%
Total	100%

* The split between relative weightage of admission test vs interview will be at the discretion of the respective school/institute.

- (iv) The Formula for calculation of merit is as follows

Matriculation	Intermediate																																
$\frac{\text{Marks Obtained}}{\text{Total Marks}} * 30$	$\frac{\text{Marks Obtained}}{\text{Total Marks}} * 45$																																
O Levels	A Levels																																
Sum of Pak. equivalent Grade Points / Marks of all subjects calculated as follows:	Sum of Pak. equivalent grade points /marks of all subjects calculated as follows:																																
<table> <tr> <th>Grades</th><th>Pak. Equivalent Grade Points/Marks</th></tr> <tr> <td>A*</td><td>4.00</td></tr> <tr> <td>A</td><td>3.20</td></tr> <tr> <td>B</td><td>2.80</td></tr> <tr> <td>C</td><td>2.40</td></tr> <tr> <td>D</td><td>2.00</td></tr> <tr> <td>E</td><td>1.60</td></tr> <tr> <td>F / U</td><td>0.00</td></tr> </table>	Grades	Pak. Equivalent Grade Points/Marks	A*	4.00	A	3.20	B	2.80	C	2.40	D	2.00	E	1.60	F / U	0.00	<table> <tr> <th>Grades</th><th>Pak. Equivalent Grade Points/Marks</th></tr> <tr> <td>A*</td><td>15.0</td></tr> <tr> <td>A</td><td>12.0</td></tr> <tr> <td>B</td><td>10.5</td></tr> <tr> <td>C</td><td>09.0</td></tr> <tr> <td>D</td><td>07.5</td></tr> <tr> <td>E</td><td>06.0</td></tr> <tr> <td>F / U</td><td>00.0</td></tr> </table>	Grades	Pak. Equivalent Grade Points/Marks	A*	15.0	A	12.0	B	10.5	C	09.0	D	07.5	E	06.0	F / U	00.0
Grades	Pak. Equivalent Grade Points/Marks																																
A*	4.00																																
A	3.20																																
B	2.80																																
C	2.40																																
D	2.00																																
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C	09.0																																
D	07.5																																
E	06.0																																
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- (v) Student terminated from one BNU school on the basis of poor academic performance will not be eligible to seek admission to any other school of BNU unless he/she meets the admissions criteria of the other school the students wishes to enroll in.

- (vi) Students terminated from BNU on disciplinary grounds will not be readmitted to the university.

Programmes Duration

The University requires students to complete their degrees within a stipulated time limit. For undergraduate and graduate qualifications, the maximum time allowance for completion of the degree is as follows: -

Program	Total Duration of Program	Extended Period (if required)	Max. Duration of Program
4 Years Bachelors	4 years	2 years	6 years
5 Years Bachelors	5 years	2 years	7 years

STRUCTURE OF BACHELOR'S DEGREE PROGRAMS (FROM REVISED POLICY BY HEC, 2023)

Nomenclature of the Degree Programs: Universities may use either of the nomenclature i.e., Bachelor of Science or Bachelor of Studies with an abbreviation of BS for undergraduate/ equivalent degree programs depending on nature of the program offered. Irrespectively, the nomenclature of the degree programs must be consistent with guidelines given in the National Qualification Framework (NQF).

Credit Hours: The standard range prescribed to qualify for the undergraduate/equivalent degree is 120-144 credit hours with a normal range of 15-18 credit hours in each semester. The university may however offer maximum of 21 credit hours in a semester where there is a program specific requirement of the same provided that the total number of credit hours for the undergraduate/equivalent degree program with a single major must not exceed beyond 144 credit hours. The range of credit hours for undergraduate/equivalent degree programs having different combinations of major(s) and minor(s) concentration must be followed as prescribed in this policy.

General Education Courses: All the undergraduate/equivalent degree programs shall be comprised of a mandatory set of 30 credit hours for general education courses as prescribed in this policy which must be covered in the first four semesters of the degree program.

Major Courses: These courses are specific to the main field of study in which the degree program is offered. The requirement to satisfy a single major is minimum of 72 credit hours for the undergraduate/equivalent degree program.

Interdisciplinary/Allied Courses: All the undergraduate/equivalent degree programs shall be comprised of a mandatory set of minimum 12 credit hours for interdisciplinary/allied courses. This is valid for all undergraduate/equivalent degree programs.

Minor (Optional): Minor is an option that comprises of secondary concentration of courses, ordinarily in an academic discipline that complements the major. The requirements and prerequisites for a minor shall be determined by the concerned department provided that a minor must not be less than 12 credit hours.

Offerings: An undergraduate/equivalent degree program may be offered with a number of combinations such as **(i)** a single major; **(ii)** a single major with one minor; **(iii)** a single major with two minors; or **(iv)** double majors without any minor. The structure of these combinations is given below:

1. Single Major: An undergraduate/equivalent degree program with a single major is focused on one disciplinary specialization and comprises of a minimum of 120 credit hours including the requirements of field experience/internship and capstone project. The breakup of credit hours is as under:

- a. General education courses: 30 credit hours
- b. Major: minimum 72 credit hours
- c. Interdisciplinary/allied courses: minimum 12 credit hours
- d. Field experience/internship: 03 credit hours
- e. Capstone project: 03 credit hours

2. Single Major with One Minor: An undergraduate/equivalent degree program with a single major and one minor is focused on one disciplinary specialization and one secondary but supporting concentration and comprises of a minimum of 132 credit hours including

the requirements of field experience/internship and capstone project. The breakup of credit hours is as under:

- a. General education courses: 30 credit hours
- b. Major: minimum 72 credit hours
- c. Interdisciplinary/allied courses: minimum 12 credit hours
- d. Minor: minimum 12 credit hours
- e. Field experience/internship: 03 credit hours
- f. Capstone project: 03 credit hours

Note: Minor will be offered subject to the approval of the relevant statutory body upon the recommendation of the concerned department.

3. Single Major with Two Minors: An undergraduate/equivalent degree program with a single major and two minors is focused on one disciplinary specialization and two secondaries but supporting concentrations and comprises of a minimum of 144 credit hours including the requirements of field experience/internship and capstone project. The breakup of credit hours is as under:

- a. General Education: 30 credit hours
- b. Major: minimum 72 credit hours
- c. Interdisciplinary/allied courses: minimum 12 credit hours
- d. Minor 1: minimum 12 credit hours
- e. Minor 2: minimum 12 credit hours
- f. Field experience/internship: 03 credit hours
- g. Capstone project: 03 credit hours

Note: Minors will be offered subject to the approval of the relevant statutory body upon the recommendation of the concerned department.

4. Double Majors: An undergraduate/equivalent degree program with double majors without any minor is focused on two related or unrelated disciplinary specializations and comprises of a minimum of 192 credit hours including the requirements of field experience/ internship and capstone project. The breakup of credit hours is as under:

- a. General Education: 30 credit hours

- b. Major 1: minimum 72 credit hours
- c. Major 2: minimum 72 credit hours
- d. Interdisciplinary/allied courses: minimum 12 credit hours
- e. Field experience/internship: 03 credit hours
- f. Capstone project: 03 credit hours

Note: A second major will be offered subject to the approval of the relevant statutory body upon recommendation of the concerned department. Additional semester(s) will be required to complete the degree requirements in case two majors are offered provided that the total duration to complete the undergraduate/equivalent degree program does not go beyond the maximum duration prescribed in HEC semester guidelines. Where two majors have common courses, a student can get exemption for maximum of 30 credit hours for the second major, in which case, the minimum requirement to complete the degree program with double major shall be 162 credit hours including the requirements of field experience/ internship and capstone project.

5. Field Experience/Internship: The field experience of six to eight weeks (preferably undertaken during semester or summer break) must be graded by a faculty member in collaboration with the supervisor in the field. This is a mandatory degree award requirement of 3 credit hours for all undergraduate/equivalent degree programs.

6. Capstone Project: A capstone project is multifaceted body of work that serves as a culminating academic and intellectual experience for students. The capstone project (preferably undertaken after the fourth semester) must be supervised and graded by a faculty member as per the protocols prescribed by the concerned department. This is a mandatory degree award requirement of 3 credit hours for all undergraduate/equivalent degree programs.

FALL/SPRING SEMESTER

- 1 There will be two regular semesters (Fall, Spring) in an academic year spread over 16-18 weeks (inclusive of 1 – 2 weeks for exams). Summer Semester will be 8 – 9 weeks of concentrated study for completing remedial course work.
- 2 Higher Education Institutes (HEIs) are at liberty to enroll students (if they fulfill their admission criteria) for Fall/Spring semester or for any single course and issue transcript with letter grades at the end of the semester. Depending on the availability of staff and

necessary facilities, HEIs can offer a summer session. Students can enroll maximum of 2 Theory courses or 1 lab course during summer sessions.

- 3 Foreign students under student exchange programme will be enrolled for any semester or for any single course and HEIs will issue transcript with letter grades at the end of the semester. Admission offer letter of the foreign student will be forwarded to HEC for issuance of NOC.

SUMMER SEMESTER

- 1 Summer semester will be offered as an optional semester of 08-09 weeks duration. Students will be offered courses to remove deficiencies and can enroll in up to a maximum of 08 credit hours during summer.
- 2 Moreover, a student who has either failed or has been stopped to take the examination due to shortage of class attendance or wishes to improve his/her grade is allowed to register in summer.
- 3 A student will only be allowed to register in 1-2 courses of upto 08 credit hours for remedial work.
- 4 The contact hours per week during the Summer Semester will be doubled to ensure that the course is completely taught in a summer session with half of the duration as compared to a regular (Fall/Spring) semester.
 - a. Course Load for Fall and Spring Semesters. An undergraduate program of instruction generally includes a 15-18 credit hours course load including exams in a regular semester. The required course load for a full time undergraduate is minimum of 15 credit hours per semester.
 - b. In case any student wishes to enroll for one more course beyond 18 credit hours s/he may be allowed by institution in either of two cases:
 - If his/her CGPA is above 3.5; and/or
 - The student needs the course to graduate on time,

ACADEMIC CALENDAR

BNU issues an academic calendar for the whole academic year (including Fall, Spring and Summer semesters, where summer is only for repeat/improvement courses). The calendar will include the following information:

- a. Semester starting date.
- b. Holidays during the semester.
- c. Semester termination date.
- d. Mid-Term exam week.
- e. Final exam week.
- f. Result notification and transcript issue dates. Each transcript will have course grades, semester Grade Point Average (GPA) and Cumulative GPA (CGPA).

Controller of Examinations will be responsible for issuing the transcripts to students and their faculty advisors in a timely manner to facilitate enrollment for the next semester or graduation.

In case the university is closed due to unusual circumstances, special makeup classes will be arranged converting weekends or holidays to working days to cover the lapsed period of the students.

ENROLLMENT/REGISTRATION IN COURSES

- a. Schools/Departments/Institutes at BNU may assign an academic advisor to each student. The advisor and the student together will develop a flexible comprehensive plan of study that will be implemented in each semester. The student's file will be updated each semester and will include copies of transcripts and GPA earned.
- b. Students are required to choose the courses they wish to enroll in, through their CMS portal, prior to the start of a semester, with the advice of their advisor. For this purpose, BNU will publish a schedule for enrollment of students.
- c. Completion of enrollment or registration is permissible solely for students whose dues have been cleared and whose status is marked as "paid" by the finance office.

- d. The fee status will be updated 24 hours after fee submission. Students must make payments accordingly to allow for processing time before completing their enrollment or registration.

ADD/DROP OF COURSES

The students may make any change i.e. add, swap or drop courses through their CMS Portal by the first week of the semester. No add/drop will be allowed once the add/drop period expires.

WITHDRAWAL FROM THE COURSES

- a. After the expiry of the add/drop deadline, students cannot drop but may withdraw from course(s) till the end of the 6th week of a regular semester, as announced in the academic calendar. Students can withdraw from courses via their CMS.
- b. Students who withdraw from courses resulting in a credit hour total below the workload prescribed by the department will not qualify for scholarships.
- c. W grade is automatically assigned by the system which shall have no impact on the calculation of the CGPA of the student. However, the transcript shall show the 'W' grade.
- d. A student withdrawing after the 6th week shall be automatically awarded "F" grade which shall count in the CGPA and stays on the transcript.

CANCELLATION OF ENROLMENT

If a student does not attend any class during the first four weeks after the commencement of the semester as per announced schedule, his/her admission shall stand cancelled automatically without any notification.

REPEATING COURSES IMPROVEMENT OF

- a. If a student gets 'F' grade, s/he will be required to repeat the course or its recommended alternate, if any. However, 'F' grade obtained earlier will also be recorded on the transcript.
- b. Undergraduate students may be allowed to repeat a course in which they have obtained grade below "C". In such a case both the previous and new grade obtained will be recorded on the transcript, however, only the better grade shall be used in the calculation of CGPA. The Institution may define maximum number (<6) of courses that student may be allowed to repeat in an eight-semester degree program.
- c. In case of CGPA improvement, it would be recorded with (Imp) on the transcript.

ATTENDANCE

Attendance in classes is mandatory. BNU students must ensure minimum attendance of 75% to complete the requirements of any course. Some courses /programs may require a higher minimum attendance rate.

The instructor may report a student's absences and the student may be placed on attendance probation by the university. A student may be dropped from the University for violating the terms of such probation.

Students must recognize that the provision for absences is not a right but meant to be used only in extreme extraneous circumstances, major emergencies or totally unavoidable circumstances. Casual absences will be considered negatively when considering any special exemptions for students who may file for absences above the maximum allowed due to genuine adverse circumstances.

EXAMINATION

In each semester, students may be required to appear in quizzes, tests, midterms, final examinations, presentations (individual/group), group discussions, and submit projects/assignments/lab reports etc. These assessment marks (to be determined by the instructor concerned) will have different weightage contributing towards the overall assessment in percentage marks. This weightage may be determined on the basis of following guidelines:

Nature of Examination	Weightage (Min/Max)
Quizzes	5 - 10%
Mid Semester Examinations	20 - 25%
Assignments/Presentations/ Practical	5 - 25%
Sessional Examination	10 - 15%
Final Examination	35 - 40%

Note: In case of a course with the composition of 4(3+1), (03 credit hour theory and 01 credit hour practical) the weightage for the practical may be considered 25%.

Ultimately, faculty awards the grade according to the instructions provided in the Syllabus. Each department evolves an honor code for Faculty to ensure objectivity, ethical authenticity of grades assigned.

In the beginning of a semester, the instructor of each course should hand out a syllabus providing information to students that defines attendance policy, grade distribution policy, assessment criteria, paper specification, examination dates, schedule of material to be taught, take-home assignment policy, required and recommended reading materials and any other information important for the successful completion of the course and its requirements.

There will be no supplementary/special examination in a semester system; if a student fails a course, s/he is required to repeat it. An incomplete grade will be awarded by the faculty only in exceptional cases beyond the control of a student such as serious accidents, family tragedy, serious health ailments, etc.

GRADING POLICY

There are two predominant and a preferred grading system applied worldwide for grading courses at all levels of tertiary education.

1. Relative Grading System (Recommended for adoption where the class size is above 20 students)
2. Absolute Grading System (Recommended for adoption where the class size is below 20 students)

The programs and courses are evaluated either on a point or percentage system (absolute grading method) or a curve (relative grading method), depending on the need for the grades to serve as a competitive filter. Because grades are mostly used for some sort of

competitive evaluation, even absolute grading systems are normalized so that they fall generally within the standard of grading practices of an institution. Most grading practices incorporate aspects of both absolute and relative grading methods.

A brief description of grade distribution is as follows:

Grade	Grade Points	Percentage obtained in a Semester System
A	3.67 - 4.00	85 and above
A-	3.34 - 3.66	80 - 84
B+	3.01 - 3.33	75 - 79
B	2.67 - 3.00	71 - 74
B-	2.34 - 2.66	68 - 70
C+	2.01 - 2.33	64 - 67
C	1.67 - 2.00	61 - 63
C-	1.31 - 1.66	58 - 60
D+	1.01 - 1.30	54 - 57
D	0.10 - 1.00	50 - 53
F	0.00	Below 50

Note: A student getting any CGPA, in absolute or relative grading, will be given the minimum of the corresponding percentage in column 3 of the table above. For example, if a student gets a CGPA of 3.00, the percentage associated will be 71%.

COMPUTATION OF GRADE POINT AVERAGE (GPA) AND CUMULATIVE GRADE POINT AVERAGE (CGPA)

GPA:

This is a figure ranging from 0.00 to 4.00 used to indicate the performance of a student in the semester concerned.

$$\text{GPA} = \frac{\text{Sum over all courses in a semester} \\ (\text{Course Credit Hours} \times \text{Grade Point Earned})}{\text{Total Semester Credit Hours}}$$

Semester Grade Point Average (GPA) and Cumulative Grade Point Averages (CGPAs) will be calculated using the following relationships:

$$\text{CGPA} = \frac{\text{Sum over all taken courses in all semesters} \\ (\text{Course Credit Hours} \times \text{Grade Point Earned})}{\text{Total Credit Hours taken in all Semesters}}$$

CGPA REQUIRED FOR THE COMPLETION OF UNDERGRADUATE DEGREE

For completion of the degree, the minimum qualifying CGPAs for BS Students are 2.00. In case a student secures less than 2.00 CGPA at the end of final semester, s/he may be allowed to get re-admission in one or more courses, in which his/her Grade is below C, along with the forthcoming semester, if s/he is not debarred under the CGPA Improvement Regulation and time duration specified for the program.

TRANSFER OF CREDIT HOURS FOR UNDERGRADUATES

- i) A student wishing to transfer from a recognized university or college to BNU will be considered subject to the following BNU regulations:

- a) Applications / NOC from the previous university for transfer to BNU must be submitted to the Registrar's Office to be reviewed by the School/Institute, in consultation with the University Equivalence Committee, to determine the position of the applicant.
- b) Courses with 'C' or above grade awarded at the transferring institution will be accepted provided the courses being considered for credit must meet the program requirements at BNU.
- c) Official records will be evaluated, and notification will be forwarded from the Registrar's Office concerning the student's position in the program at BNU, including the number of credits awarded.
- d) At least 50% of the credits required for a degree must be earned at BNU.
- e) Students with CGPA below 2.0 are NOT eligible to apply for 'Transfer of Credits'
- f) Transfer Credits from other institutions shall not be counted towards the GPA and CGPA. However, transfer credits may be considered towards the fulfilment of the requirement for a degree after an evaluation by the University Equivalence Committee.

FREEZING OF SEMESTER

- a. If a student freezes a semester(s), s/he will resume his/her studies from the same stage where s/he left (froze). Students need to submit semester freeze application two week prior from the commencement of classes and in special circumstance they are allowed until 3rd semester. No freezing will be allowed after 3rd semester. The maximum duration of the degree program shall not be affected by any frozen semester.
- b. If a student is not enrolled in any course in a semester, s/he will not be considered a regular student of university in that period. The student may then enroll in these courses in a subsequent semester; however, s/he will have to meet pre-requisites of any course taken. In addition, it is understood that the university is not required to offer all courses in each semester.
- c. In special hardship cases, the University may develop any criteria for freezing a semester with the prior permission of the Vice Chancellor. A medical certificate must be duly signed by the University Medical Officer (if that is the reason).

- d. The duration of Freezing is one year; a candidate who gets a semester freeze can get readmission next year with upcoming session, but hardship cases can be considered by the competent authority only.
- e. Freezing of first semester in the freshman year is not allowed except under special hardship circumstances by the prior approval of the vice chancellor.

MEDICAL CERTIFICATE:

Only a medical certificate from a registered medical practitioner duly endorsed by the University Medical Officer will be considered. But mere submission of certificate does not guarantee the requested relaxation.

INDISCIPLINE IN EXAMINATIONS

Any candidate found guilty of the following matters can be directly penalized in terms of course evaluation/grade by the Instructor.

The Instructor can further submit the case to the Unfair Means Cases Committee constituted by the University.

The committee will include two (2) senior faculty members, -Controller Examination, Registrar headed by senior Professor of the University.

- (i) Submits forged or fake documents in connection with the examination.
- (ii) Commits impersonation in the examination.
- (iii) Copies from any paper, book or notes.
- (iv) Mutilates the Answer Book to conceal any evidence of wrongdoing.
- (v) Possesses any kind of material without prior permission of the instructor, which may be helpful to his/her in the examination.
- (vi) Does anything that is immoral or illegal in connection with the examination and which may be helpful to him/her in the examination.
- (vii) Refuses to obey the invigilation staff or refuses to follow the instructions issued by the University in connection with the examination.
- (viii) Misbehaves or creates any kind of disturbance in or around the examination center.

- (ix) Uses abusive or obscene language on the answer script.
- (x) Possesses any kind of weapon in or around the examination centre.
- (xi) Possesses any kind of unauthorized electronic device which may be helpful in the examination.

His/her case shall result in penalties keeping in view the nature and intensity of offence, which could be:

- (i) Cancellation of paper*.
- (ii) Suspension from program for one semester.
- (iii) Fine
- (iv) Expulsion from the University.
- (v) Any other

* Unfair Means Cases Committee will decide if the student will have to appear in summer semester/with regular semester for the cancelled paper.

Appeal against the decision of the Unfair Means cases Committee.

If a student is not satisfied by the decision of the Unfair Means Cases Committee, s/he can appeal against the decision within a week after the decision of the Committee to the Vice Chancellor.

ACADEMIC PROBATIONS

Academic probation is a warning to the student that their grades or overall academic standing are not meeting the university's set criteria which is as follows:

- I. Students who fail to maintain a minimum required CGPA of 2.00 (in case of bachelor's degree) and 2.50 (in case of MA/MS/M. Phil degree) are placed on academic probation.
- II. On two (2) probations in the first year or three (3) consecutive probations in the subsequent years, a student's name shall be automatically removed from the university's rolls.

- III. However, students may consult their academic counsellor to pursue another course of study at BNU.

STUDENT GRIEVANCES AGAINST COURSE INSTRUCTOR AND RECHECKING OF EXAMINATION SCRIPT

If a student disagrees with the assessment of their work by the instructor, they may file an appeal by following the mentioned steps:

- I. a written request for a review of the course grade to the office of the Dean within 7 days of receiving the grade/provisional transcript, along with a fee PKR 3000 for each course subject to rechecking.
- II. The Dean / Head of the Department shall arrange for an impartial evaluation of the grade.
- III. The Dean/Head of the Department will notify the student, faculty member, and Controller of Examinations of the outcome of the re-evaluation within ten days of receiving the review request.
- IV. As a result of re-evaluation, the marks of a student may increase, decrease, or remain the same. If there's a change of marks, the record shall be updated accordingly, and a revised transcript will be issued.
- V. No further appeals will be allowed against the re-evaluation and the decision shall stand final.

MATTERS RELATED TO DEGREES CONFERMENT

BNU conducts the Convocation once in a year to award the degrees to the qualified students as per criteria.

Degrees will not be issued before the convocation under any circumstances. However, if necessary, a student may apply for a Final Transcript or a 'Provisional Certificate of Degree'.

Issuance of Duplicate Degree

In the event of a lost or damaged original degree, or if there's a name change for a candidate, students may apply for a duplicate degree by paying the required fee of PKR 5000. for regular processing and PKR. 10,000. The application must be accompanied by the following documents:

- a. For a damaged degree, the original degree must be submitted.
- b. For a lost degree, a copy of the FIR (First Information Report) is required.
- c. For a name change, documentary evidence is necessary.

AWARDS AND DISTINCTIONS

Dean's Honor List Students with excellent academic performance during a semester are placed on the Dean's Honor List. The eligibility criteria for inclusion are:

- Achieving a GPA of 3.50 or higher in a semester.

Completing the full workload for a semester as prescribed by the School/ Institute.

Award of Gold Medal

The Gold Medal will be awarded to the student with the highest CGPA in each degree program provided number of graduating students of the same batch (i.e. Fall & Spring) in each degree program is not less than 10 in case of the undergraduate program and 5 in case of the graduate program. In the case of less than 5 students in MS/M.Phil. program(s), all MS/M.Phil. programs of the same school/institute may be considered as ONE batch for the award of Gold Medal on the recommendation of the respective Dean/Director. With this provision the eligibility for the award of Gold Medal will be determined by the following criteria:

- a. If the average CGPA of cohort for a degree is 3.25 or above, then the minimum required CGPA would be 3.80. If the average CGPA of cohort for a degree is less than 3.25 then the minimum required CGPA would be 3.65.
- b. The academic record of the students should neither have an 'F' grade nor should he/she has repeated the course.
- c. There should be no disciplinary case or warning against him/her in their record.
- d. If two students attain the same highest cumulative grade point average, then each of them will receive a Gold Medal.
- e. While considering a student for the award of Gold Medal student's attendance and disciplinary record may be considered.

- f. Any matter not covered under this policy shall be forwarded to the Gold Medal Committee constituted by the Vice Chancellor.

FEE STRUCTURE AND TYPES

The students will be charged following types of fees at rates prescribed from time to time by the University:

Application Processing Fee: A one-time Application Processing fee is charged from all the applicants who apply for admission at BNU.

Admission Fee: Admission fee will be charged only from newly admitted students. This fee will be paid only once during the study in an academic program and is non-refundable.

Tuition Fee: Tuition fees will be paid in advance at the beginning of each semester or in installments according to university policy.

Hostel Fee: Hostel fee will be charged from the students availing the boarding and lodging facility. This fee will be charged in advance before the start of each semester.

Security Deposit: Security Deposit will be paid at the time of admission. Security is refundable only at the time of withdrawal/passing out of the student. Any amount recoverable from the student will be adjusted against the security at the end of his/her academic program.

Medical Insurance Fee: A medical insurance fee will be charged at the beginning of each semester. There is no exception even for students who are only taking short courses, reduced credit hours, summer Programs etc. Students who will pay fee in installments, insurance fee will be charged in 'First Installment'. This fee will be non-refundable.

Other Types of Fees: In addition to the above-mentioned fees, other types of fee may be charged as determined and approved by the university. Procedure for collection will be updated from time to time.

PAYMENT OF DUES

A student's registration for a semester will not be considered as complete until all outstanding fees are settled, or acceptable payment arrangements are agreed upon with the Finance Department.

Rules and procedures for registration:

- a. Challan forms are issued by the Finance Department upon request from the Registrar's Office.
- b. The full semester fee (or one instalment) must be paid at least one week prior to the start of the semester.
- c. In case of delayed fee payment after the due date, a fine of Rs. 100 per day will be imposed.
- d. If fees remain unpaid for more than two weeks after the semester begins, the student's name will be automatically removed from the program of study.
- e. Re-admission can be granted solely at the discretion of the Dean and is contingent on the payment of admission fees in addition to the outstanding dues and fines.

PAYMENT OF DUES BY NEWLY ADMITTED STUDENTS

Applicants who receive an offer of admission must make the necessary payments prior to the commencement of their studies to confirm and secure their admission. Any applicant who fails to pay their dues by the specified due date will lose their right to admission.

FEE INSTALLMENTS

1. Fee installment will be allowed to the students with proven need due to financial hardships.

2. Only tuition fee can be paid in installments. The maximum number of installments can be three (3). However, in very exceptional circumstances the time for the payment of installment may be extended by the V.C.
3. The name of the student will be automatically deleted from the rolls of the university in case of non-payment of installment on valid date.
4. Application for fee installments in case of new admission will only be entertained if the initial challan for all other fees except the tuition fee has been paid and submitted to Registrar's Office.
5. An application for fee installment will be submitted to Registrar's Office. All applications recommended or not recommended will be sent to Finance Department.
6. All applications for fee installment will be processed within a week of submission.

MODE OF PAYMENT

Students obtain their Challan Forms from the Finance Department and then make the required payment at the designated bank. All payments must be made in cash, by pay order, or with a demand draft payable to Beaconhouse National University. Additionally, it is possible to make fee payments through Visa/Master Cards at BNU, with applicable bank charges. Fee can also be paid online as explained below.

Online Payment Method

BNU has launched an Online Payment Facility through which students can pay their fees and other dues **Online** via **NIFTePay** by logging into their CMS account.

Step 1 >> Login to your CMS Account

Step 2 >> Go to Student Financials

Step 2 >> Go to Fee Challans

Step 3 >> Select Unpaid Challan

Step 4>> Click on the Pay Online button.

Step 5>> Select Payment Method (Via Card or Via Bank Account)

After selecting the payment method the page will appear with fee dues. You need to press the 'Pay Online button.

Paying Through Credit Card:

The following are the required credentials for paying through your Credit Card:

1. Card Number
2. CVV
3. Name on Card
4. Expiry Month
5. Expiry Year

After you have entered the above information, press the 'Proceed' button. An OTP (One-time Password) will be sent to the Credit Card Holder's registered cell number. Enter that OTP and press the submit button.

Paying through Bank Account:

The following are the required credentials for paying through the Bank Account:

1. Bank Name
2. Account Number
3. CNIC Number

After you have entered the above information, press the 'Proceed' button. An OTP (One-time Password) will be sent to the Bank Account Holder's registered cell number. Enter that OTP and press the submit button. Login here <https://cms.bnu.edu.pk/login> For any queries please contact BNU Finance Office.

WITHDRAWAL FROM ACADEMIC PROGRAM

If a student decides to withdraw from or take a break from their program of study, they must complete and submit the Student's Clearance Form to the Registrar's Office. The effective date of withdrawal will be considered as the date when the completed Clearance Form is submitted to the Registrar's Office. It's important to note that students who do not follow this process will not be eligible for any fee refunds or security deposits.

FEE REFUND POLICY

Fees are generally non-refundable. However, if a student needs to withdraw from the academic program due to extenuating circumstances beyond their control, they may be eligible for a

partial fee refund as outlined below:

- a. If the withdrawal is requested during the first week of the semester, a 100% refund will be given (excluding the admission fee for new admissions).
- b. If the withdrawal is requested during the second or third week of the semester, a 50% refund will be provided (excluding the admission fee for new admissions).
- c. After the third week, no refund will be granted.
- d. The basis for fee refund calculations will be the date when the withdrawal application is submitted to the Registrar's Office.
- e. It's essential to note that fees will not be refunded if a student is expelled or suspended for disciplinary reasons or any reasons unrelated to academic performance.
- f. Additionally, in the event that an applicant becomes ineligible to continue studies at BNU upon the declaration of High school results, an 80% tuition fee refund will be applicable if the application is made within 10 days of the result declaration, along with supporting evidence of ineligibility.

FEE INSTALLMENTS

- a. Fee installments will be considered for students who can demonstrate a genuine financial need due to financial hardships.
- b. Only the tuition fee is eligible for installment payments. The maximum number of installments allowed is three (3). However, under very exceptional circumstances, the deadline for the payment of the third installment may be extended by the Vice-Chancellor.

- c. Failure to pay an installment by the specified due date will result in the automatic blockage of attendance and absenteeism marked during that time period will not be exempted.
- d. For new admissions, requests for fee installments will only be accepted if the initial challan for all other fees, except the tuition fee, has been paid.
- e. To apply for fee installments, students should submit Request through e-portal.
- f. Fee installments will be approved for one semester at a time. Students must apply for fee installments separately for each semester. Students who default on their payments in a semester may not be eligible for installment arrangements in the following semester.
- g. The processing of all applications for fee installments will be completed within 24 hours of the submission of request.

CHANGE OF PROGRAM OF STUDY

- a) Students of BNU who wish to switch to the degree program of another School within BNU can apply for within one year from the date of their admission. After one year, they cannot apply for and must seek fresh admission.
- b) Requests for internal transfers (i.e., transfers within the same school) shall be evaluated and finalized by the school's faculty following BNU's Student Transfer Policy, with notification sent to the Offices of Registrar and Examination.
- c) Students with a CGPA below 2.0 are NOT eligible to apply for 'Transfer of Credits'.
- d) All 'Transfer of Credits Program' requests must be submitted to the Office of Registrar within two weeks from the commencement of classes. Requests received after this period will not be entertained.

If a student decides to change their academic program to a different one, they will be Required to pay the tuition fees associated with the new program. This means that the tuition fees for the new program will apply, and any previous payments made for the previous program may not be transferable or refundable.

SCHOLARSHIP / FINANCIAL ASSISTANCE POLICY

- a. While awarding a scholarship (merit or need-based) a student's attendance and disciplinary record is also taken into consideration.
- b. The total Scholarship (Merit and Need) will not exceed 100% of the total tuition fee.
- c. Merit and Need based scholarship will be awarded as per following policy

MERIT SCHOLARSHIP (UNDERGRADUATES)

For New Admissions:

Students with 80% or above marks in their FA/FSc examination; or the students with two (2) 'A' Grades in the A-Level examination; or the students with 3.80 CGPA in High School Diploma or equivalent will be eligible for a scholarship. This scholarship will continue if the students maintain the CGPA as mentioned in the following table: -

CGPA	A-LEVEL	FA / FSC % AGE	MERIT SCHOLARSHIP	CONDITION TO CONTINUE
3.80 - 3.89	2 - A's	80% to 89%	50% of the Tuition Fee	Maintains CGPA with full prescribed workload in all subsequent semesters (3.80 - 3.89)
3.90 - 4.00	3 - A's	90% & above	75% of the Tuition Fee	Maintains CGPA with full prescribed workload in all subsequent semesters (3.90 - 4.00)

For Existing Students:

Students with a CGPA of 3.50 or higher with full workload as prescribed by school/department at the end of each semester will be entitled to a scholarship as per following table. This scholarship will continue if the students maintain the CGPA as mentioned in the following table:

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CGPA	MERIT SCHOLARSHIP	CONDITION TO CONTINUE
3.50 - 3.64	25% of the tuition fee	Maintains CGPA with full prescribed workload in all subsequent semesters (3.50 - 3.64)

3.65 - 3.79	35% of the tuition fee	Maintains CGPA with full prescribed workload in all subsequent semesters (3.65 - 3.79)
3.80 - 3.89	50% of the tuition fee	Maintains CGPA with full prescribed workload in all subsequent semesters (3.80 - 3.89)
3.90 - 4.00	75% of the tuition fee	Maintains CGPA with full prescribed workload in all subsequent semesters (3.90 - 4.00)

For more information on the Scholarships (Need and Merit) please visit the following link:
www.bnu.edu.pk/bnu/admissions/fee-scholarship

ACADEMIC HONOR CODE TO ENSURE STUDENT AND FACULTY ACADEMIC INTEGRITY

BNU has a code of academic integrity for all students to stay away from academic dishonesty in all scholarly endeavors. For any violation of the code, appropriate disciplinary steps prescribed in the honor code will be taken.

HEC policy for plagiarism will be a prominent part of the Honor Code. A clearly defined process of due diligence is in effect at BNU to deter academic dishonesty and promote ethical principles governing academic behavior.

Use of University Resources

At BNU, responsible use of university facilities and resources is essential for the well-being of the academic community. Students and staff are expected to utilize these resources responsibly, ensuring their protection and sustainability. Vandalism, theft, or misuse of university property will lead to disciplinary consequences.

Social Media and Online Behavior

BNU recognizes the significance of responsible and respectful use of social media and online communication. Students and staff are expected to use these platforms in a manner that upholds the university's values and standards. Compliance with the rules is essential for maintaining a

positive and respectful online environment. Violations are met with appropriate penalties, reinforcing the significance of responsible online behavior.

Drugs and Banned Substance Use

BNU maintains a strict zero-tolerance policy regarding the possession or consumption of drugs and other banned illegal substances on campus.

BNU is committed to maintaining a drug-free campus to ensure the safety and well-being of all members of the university community. Compliance with these rules is essential for upholding the zero-tolerance policy. Violations are met with appropriate penalties, emphasizing the university's commitment to a drug-free environment.

The university has designated specific outdoor spaces as smoking/vaping zones, smoking/vaping is only allowed in these areas. Heavy fines/confiscation of cigarettes/vapes may be employed in case of smoking/vaping anywhere else on campus.

Bullying and Ragging and Harassment

BNU is dedicated to ensuring a safe, inclusive, and respectful environment for all members of its community. Bullying/Ragging and Harassment are not allowed under any circumstances.

Compliance with relevant rules is essential for upholding these principles and protecting the rights and well-being of all individuals. Violations are met with appropriate penalties, emphasizing the university's commitment to eliminating bullying, ragging, and harassment.

Sexual Harassment

Sexual harassment includes any unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, or other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature that create a hostile or intimidating environment. These rules have been established in accordance with the Sexual Harassment Policy (2023) chalked out by the Higher Education Commission, to address and prevent sexual harassment at BNU. They apply to all members of the BNU community and visitors.

LIBRARY

We aspire to be the best possible library for the BNU community and are committed to excellence of service. We create opportunities to participate, connect, and discover by encouraging lifelong learning, ensuring freedom of access to information; and offering space for people and ideas to come together.

BNU has a multi-disciplinary library serving the faculty, students, researchers, and staff of the university. The library has an extensive collection of printed and electronic books, electronic journals, magazines, catalogs, and other materials including VHS, CDs, DVDs, and Company Reports etc. The books and other reading materials are cataloged according to the specific nature of the collections. The library uses the Dewey Decimal Classification scheme to classify and shelve its knowledge resources. It starts from 000 and goes to 999 in decimal order.

Library General Rules

Users are expected to observe the following rules for smooth and effective library services:

1. Every enrolled student of the university is a member of the BNU library.
2. Leave your personal belongings in the designated shelf. The library disclaims any liability for loss or damage.
3. Submit any book or object for inspection, when requested by the library staff.
4. Do not write, underline, or mark any book. Library books are carefully examined on return and the borrower will be held responsible for the damage. A fine equivalent to the cost of purchase of a replacement copy will be imposed if the book is mishandled.
5. After reading, leave books on the table or on the book trolley. Please do not shelve the books.
6. While returning library books or other materials at the circulation desk, please ensure that the circulation staff has received those properly.
7. Report lost book(s) or other material(s) to the library immediately through email or personally at the circulation desk to avoid overdue fines.
8. Complete silence should be observed except for brief and subdued talk with the library staff.
9. No group discussions are to be held in the library.
10. Drinks and eatables are not allowed in the library. Violations may cause a fine of Rs.1000.
11. Keep your mobiles switched off or on silent mode within the library premises.
12. Smoking is strictly prohibited inside the library building.
13. Sleeping is prohibited in the library.

14. Any disruptive/unethical activities may cause a fine and cancelation of library membership.
15. Wearing shorts is strictly not allowed in the library.

CIRCULATION POLICY

The aim of the Circulation Desk is to encourage the optimal use of reading material for the purpose of study, teaching, and research. The major tasks performed by the Circulation Section are check-out and check-in of circulation materials through user registration/relationship services; maintenance of user services area; maintenance of and check-out policy data including all records of library patrons; renewal and overdue notices, among others.

LIBRARY ACCESS

Students, faculty, and staff of BNU can access the library's collection and all its services with borrowing privileges as specified below:

Books

Postgraduate Students	04 Books	14 Days
Undergraduate/ Graduate Students	02 Books	14 Days
Staff	02 Books	14 Days
Permanent Faculty	06 Books	30 Days
Visiting Faculty	04 Books	30 Days

Non-book material issuing policy.

- Reference Books, Pamphlets, Catalogues, and Magazines are not to be issued.
- The current issue of any magazine will not be issued.
- Newspapers of a particular day will not be issued.
- Older newspapers can be issued for a maximum of 7 days.
- Theses and projects can only be consulted within the library premises.

Reservation

Patrons can reserve an item that is already issued to someone else online by using Library OPAC (Online Public Access Catalog) from anywhere. The library will inform the requester to collect the required item through e-mail or telephone as soon as it reaches the library. If the item is not collected within two days, the reservation will be considered canceled.

Fines:

A fine is charged for each day the book remains overdue. Library users would pay a fine Rs.100 for each item per day in case of late submission. The idea behind realizing the fine to discourage late returns and to provide equal opportunity to all the patrons to utilize the library resources.

Lost Books

- Library users are required to inform the library immediately in case of lost library items.
- The patron cannot provide a replacement copy directly unless the patron is the author of the work.
- In case of loss or damage, the user will be charged three times the current price of the item and a 25% additional fine in case of item is lost and the user does not inform the library.
- Patrons responsible for losing the book will have their user status frozen till the payment for the replacement/fine is paid.
- Librarians do not have the authority to waive or reduce fines, only Vice Chancellor can do so.
- The library will send a minimum of three reminders to its users regarding borrowed books. The first reminder will be sent within 15 days of the book's issuance, the second will follow 15 days after the first reminder, and the third will be sent another 15 days later if the library books have not been returned. The library will inform the accounts and finance department about the fines of any patron. These will be deducted from faculty/staff salaries/added to the students' fee challans.

Theft

The willful damage or theft of library material will result in an automatic referral to higher management and proceedings as per university rules and policies.

Concluding note:

This handbook offers clear guidance for navigating university policies and procedures. Consider it your compass, directing you through your academic journey and empowering you to make informed decisions.

As a student at BNU, staying informed and engaged is your responsibility. Be proactive by regularly checking your university email, CMS, and staying updated via the BNU website. Critical announcements, deadlines, and opportunities will be communicated through these channels. Remaining informed will prevent you from missing out on any valuable information or opportunities.
